

MacSync

MES Large Events Management Platform

Member Guide

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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 About MacSync

MacSync is an event management platform built for the McMaster Engineering Society (MES). It gives McMaster students a single place to discover events, purchase tickets, and manage their registrations — all through a dedicated mobile app available on iOS and Android.

1.2 Who This Guide Is For

This guide is for **Members** — any registered McMaster student using the MacSync mobile app to browse and attend events. If you are a staff member or administrator, refer to the *MacSync Staff & Admin Guide*.

1.3 How to Use This Guide

Read Chapter 2 to get set up, then jump to whichever section covers what you need. Callout boxes highlight important information:

Note

Notes provide extra context or background information.

Warning

Warnings flag actions that could have unintended consequences.

Tip

Tips share best practices and useful shortcuts.

1.4 System Requirements

- iOS or Android smartphone with the MacSync app installed.
- Active internet connection.
- A valid @mcmaster.ca email address.

Chapter 2

Getting Started

2.1 Downloading the App

The MacSync mobile app is available on both platforms:

- **iOS:** Search *MacSync* on the Apple App Store.
- **Android:** Search *MacSync* on the Google Play Store.

2.2 Creating an Account

1. Open the MacSync app.
2. Tap **Sign Up**.
3. Enter your @mcmaster.ca email address.
4. A **verification code** will be sent to your McMaster inbox.
5. Enter the verification code in the app to confirm your email.
6. Complete your profile and set a password.
7. Tap **Create Account**.

Note

Only valid @mcmaster.ca email addresses can register on MacSync. Non-McMaster emails will not receive a verification code.

2.3 Logging In

1. Open the MacSync app.
2. Enter your @mcmaster.ca email and password.
3. Tap **Sign In**.

2.4 Navigating the App

Once logged in, the bottom navigation bar gives you access to four sections:

- **Events** — Browse all upcoming open events and sign up.
- **My Tickets** — View your active and past tickets.
- **Notifications** — View event announcements and updates.
- **Profile** — Manage your account information.

2.5 Logging Out

Tap **Logout** in the top-right corner of the app. You will be returned to the login screen.

Chapter 3

Browsing & Registering for Events

3.1 Browsing Events

The **Events** tab shows all upcoming open events. Each event card displays:

- Event name, date, and location.
- Number of registered attendees.
- Ticket price (or *Free* if no charge).
- An **Open** badge if registration is currently available.

Use the search bar at the top to find a specific event by name.

3.2 Registering for a Free Event

1. Tap an event card to view its details.
2. If the event has table or bus signup enabled, you will be prompted to select your preferred seat before confirming.
3. Tap **Sign Up** to complete registration.

Once registered, the event card will show a **Signed Up** badge.

3.3 Registering for a Paid Event

1. Tap an event card to view its details.

2. If seat selection is required, choose your table or bus seat.
3. Tap **Proceed to payment**.
4. The **Stripe checkout screen** will appear within the app. You can pay using:
 - **Link** — Stripe’s saved payment method for faster checkout.
 - **Card** — Enter your card number, expiry, CVV, cardholder name, and country.
5. Tap **Pay** to complete your purchase.

Note

Your @mcmaster.ca email is pre-filled in the Stripe checkout form. You can optionally save your card via Stripe Link for faster checkout next time.

3.4 Table & Bus Seat Selection

Some events require you to choose a seat as part of registration:

- **Table signup** — Select your preferred table number and seat at that table. There is no visual seating map; selection is by number.
- **Bus signup** — Select your preferred bus number and seat on that bus.

Your seat selection is shown on your ticket after registration.

Chapter 4

My Tickets

4.1 Viewing Your Tickets

Tap **My Tickets** in the bottom navigation bar. Tickets are organised into two tabs:

- **Current** — Active upcoming tickets.
- **Past & Refunded** — Tickets for past events or processed refunds.

Each ticket card shows the event name, date, location, price, and your seat assignment (if applicable).

4.2 Your Entry QR Code

Tap **View details** on any ticket to open the full ticket page, which includes:

- Event location, price, and seat assignment.
- An **Entry QR Code** — show this to event staff at the entrance for check-in.
- A **Request Refund** button.
- Your unique **Ticket ID**.

Tip

Save a screenshot of your QR code before the event in case you lose internet connection on the day.

4.3 Requesting a Refund

1. Go to **My Tickets** and tap the relevant ticket.
2. Tap **View details**.
3. Tap **Request Refund** (shown in red).

Once processed, the ticket will move to the **Past & Refunded** tab.

Warning

Refund eligibility may depend on the event organiser's policy. Contact the organiser directly if your refund request is not processed.

Chapter 5

Notifications

5.1 Receiving Notifications

MacSync sends notifications to keep you informed about events you are registered for. You will receive them in two ways:

- **Push notification** on your device (if notifications are enabled for the MacSync app in your phone settings).
- **In-app** under the **Notifications** tab, which shows a badge count for unread items.

5.2 Types of Notifications

- **Ticket confirmation** — Sent automatically when you successfully register for an event (e.g. “*You’re registered for [Event]! Your ticket has been confirmed.*”).
- **Event announcements** — Sent by event staff with updates or reminders (e.g. “*Remember to bring your student ID!*”).

Notifications appear in reverse chronological order. Unread ones are marked with a dot. Tap **Mark All Read** to clear all unread indicators.

Chapter 6

Account Settings

6.1 Viewing Your Profile

Tap **Profile** in the bottom navigation bar to view your account information:

- Name and role (e.g. Member).
- Email address (cannot be changed).
- Phone number.
- McMaster program.
- In-App Notifications toggle.

6.2 Editing Your Profile

1. Tap **Profile**, then tap **Edit Profile**.
2. Update any of the following:
 - Name
 - Phone number
 - Program
 - In-App Notifications toggle
3. Tap **Save Changes** to apply, or **Cancel** to discard.

Note

Your **email address** is linked to your McMaster account and cannot be changed after registration.

6.3 Notification Preferences

The **In-App Notifications** toggle controls whether you receive push notifications from MacSync:

- **On** — Notifications are delivered to your device and visible in the **Notifications** tab.
- **Off** — Notifications are silenced, but you can still view them manually in the **Notifications** tab.

Chapter 7

Glossary

Check-in	The process of having your QR code scanned at the event entrance to confirm your attendance.
Entry QR Code	A unique scannable code on your ticket used for event check-in.
Event	A scheduled activity organised by an MES club or society, visible to all MacSync members.
Member	The default role for every registered MacSync user.
MES	McMaster Engineering Society — the organisation that operates the MacSync platform.
Stripe	The payment processor used by MacSync for paid event registrations.
Ticket ID	A unique identifier assigned to each ticket purchase.